



CLIENT TRAINING · ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT · BUDGET & TAXONOMY

Your Numbers. Finally Working for You.

Marketing Budget Upload and Marketing Calendar Bulk Upload in Verilume: why one confirmed budget changes every recommendation the platform makes, what you get back, and the steps that take you from a spreadsheet to a live media plan.

Read time: 15 minutes · Setup time: 45 minutes with your budget file in hand · Payback: the first plan the AI builds

SESSION ONE

The spreadsheet that runs the company

Every marketing organization has one: the budget workbook. It's been passed between owners for years, it has tabs nobody opens, subtotals nobody trusts, and a "Grand Total" row that gets added into itself at least once a year. It is also, quietly, the single most important document in marketing — because every plan, every channel decision and every "can we afford it?" conversation starts there.

Verilume asks for that file once, in whatever shape it's in. It finds the month columns, spots the subtotal rows so they aren't double-counted, and asks you to match your categories to its own. From that moment the platform is planning with your real dollars: the Media Plan is pre-filled from your budget, Campaign Creation offers only the channels you've funded, and the AI Brain answers "how much is left in Direct Mail?" with a number instead of a guess.

Its companion, the Marketing Calendar Bulk Upload, does the same for history: your past campaigns and their line items go in once, and the calendar, product-group rollups and the AI Brain's "what worked before" context all light up.

What changes when the budget is confirmed

Before	After
The AI recommends channels you don't fund.	Campaign Creation offers Active Channels only — the ones with real dollars behind them.
The media plan starts from a blank grid.	Steps 1–4 of the Media Plan wizard arrive pre-filled from your upload.
"How much have we committed?" is a Friday email.	The AI Brain sees confirmed dollars, dollars already drawn by other campaigns, and what remains — per category.
Non-working spend hides inside media totals.	Working and non-working are separated; production and fees never inflate a channel.
Last year's campaigns live in someone's head.	The calendar shows them, and the AI Brain cites their conversions per \$1k.

The stakes

A recommendation is only as good as the constraint it respects. Give the platform your real budget and every plan it builds is one you can actually execute. Skip it and you'll spend the year translating good ideas into what you can afford.

SESSION TWO

What's in the box

Two tiles under Account Management → Budget & Taxonomy. One is for dollars, one is for history.

1. Marketing Budget Upload

"Upfront upload only — ongoing allocation lives in Strategy." You choose a **Budget scope** (Domestic or International) and a **Budget year**, then one of three starts: **Upload budget**, **Manually add**, or **Leverage previous year**. The upload path accepts .csv or .xlsx, detects your layout automatically, skips total rows, and brings you to a review screen laid out like a financial statement where you map each of your working-media categories to a Verilume category. Confirm, and the budget is live.

The template

Category, Working / Non-Working, Jan, Feb, Mar, Apr, May, Jun, Jul, Aug, Sep, Oct, Nov, Dec, Total

One row per sub-channel is the recommended grain (Paid Search, Paid Social, Direct Mail...). Never list a whole-channel row *and* its sub-channel rows for the same dollars — that double-counts. Production, agency fees, tools and research go in as Non-Working; they're tracked, never mixed into media.

What you get back once it's confirmed

Surface	What it shows
Plan Setup	Status "✓ Active" for the year and scope.
Budget detail	Marketing Loop allocations, channel totals with sub-channels, the monthly distribution; non-working spend shown separately with a read-only total marketing spend line.
Chart cards	Plan Pacing, Budget Tracking, Channel Media Mix, Marketing Loop, ROAS.
Active Channels	The channels Campaign Creation will offer, recalculated from any mapped category with dollars.
Upload history	The audit trail of every file, who uploaded it, and its status.
Export	A monthly-detail CSV — one row per category, Jan–Dec plus Total.

2. Marketing Calendar Bulk Upload

"A one-time historical import — not the live calendar." Two steps: first your **Product Groups** and **Creative Focus Groups** (upload a one-column list or type them), then a CSV of campaigns and their channel lines, with a date range for the file. The template columns are:

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campaignName, campaignClassification, campaignStartDate, campaignEndDate, channel, partner, audience, buyType, mediaType, impressions, dropDate, hitDate, endDate, productYear, productGroup, creativeMarket, budget
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Each row is one channel line on one campaign. Channel must be one of the platform's 18 standard channels; product group and creative market must match the lists from step one; dates are yyyy-mm-dd; impressions and budget are non-negative numbers; up to 2,000 rows per file.

SESSION THREE

The budget upload, step by step

Path: Account Management → Budget & Taxonomy → Marketing Budget Upload, or Next from Competitive Positioning in the Configuration sequence. The page opens on the Annual Media Plan; the section you want is headed "Budget setup".

01 Get the file honest before you upload it

Open your budget workbook and make three passes. Delete or ignore subtotal and grand-total rows (the platform skips rows labelled like totals, but don't rely on it for oddly named ones). Make sure each spend line appears once — a "Digital" row plus "Paid Search" and "Paid Social" rows for the same money is the classic double-count. Add a Working / Non-Working column if you don't have one. If your file is messy, download the sample template and paste your numbers into it; it's faster than fixing the original.

02 Choose scope and year first

On the Plan Setup card pick **Domestic** or **International** and the **Budget year**. The year must be chosen before you upload — the platform will refuse a file without one. Only Domestic budgets drive Active Channels and the AI Brain's budget context; International budgets confirm normally and stand on their own.

03 Upload

On "Upload your budget file", optionally enter who's uploading (for the audit trail), press **Choose file to upload...** and pick your .csv or .xlsx. The file is virus- and PII-scanned, then analyzed: the platform finds the month and total columns from the headers and imports with its best-guess mapping. There's no column-by-column confirmation screen; if the layout came in wrong, fix it on the next screen or re-upload a cleaner file.

04 Map your categories — "Review your budget"

Working media is listed first. Each of your raw categories shows a suggested Verilume category in a dropdown, from Total Channel down to sub-category. Correct any that guessed wrong. Use **Split into ... sub-channels** → to break a lump sum into its parts. Non-working lines pass through underneath with an editable label and need no mapping. Only working categories must be mapped; a custom "Client: *name*" category is allowed for anything that doesn't fit. The platform remembers each match, so next year's file maps itself.

05 Submit as final

Press **Submit as final**. The upload becomes the confirmed budget for that year and scope, Active Channels are recalculated, and the page moves you into the Media Plan with Steps 1–4 pre-filled — opening on Step 2, Stage Weighting. From here it's Strategy's job.

06 Import campaign history

Back under Budget & Taxonomy, open **Marketing Calendar Bulk Upload**. Step 1: load your Product Groups and Creative Focus Groups. Step 2: set the file's date range, download the CSV template, fill it (one row per channel line), upload, review the preview, and press **Upload valid rows** →. Every batch is listed under Uploaded files and can be deleted as a batch — if you need to redo a file, delete its batch first so nothing is counted twice.

SESSION FOUR

Where the numbers show up

Feature	What it reads from your uploads
Media Plan wizard	Pre-fills budget, stage weighting, channel mix and monthly curve from the confirmed upload; "Prefill" re-seeds it.
Active Channels / Campaign Creation	Offers only channels with mapped dollars; unfunded channels show "No budget identified".
AI Brain (Collaboration Center)	Up to 15 budget categories with confirmed dollars, dollars drawn by other campaigns and what remains; the plan mix by stage (prior year as fallback); past campaigns' conversions per \$1k.
Budget chart cards and CSV export	Pacing, Tracking, Channel Media Mix, Marketing Loop, ROAS; monthly detail export.
Marketing Calendar and rollups	Every bulk-uploaded line becomes a calendar entry and feeds the Product Group / Creative Focus Group rollups.

Coaching notes from the field

One confirmed budget per year and scope.

A second upload for the same year is refused. Adjust category totals from the existing upload's review screen, or delete it first — and if campaigns are already drawing on that year's plan, the delete will list them and ask you to confirm twice. That's protection, not friction.

Working vs. non-working is not cosmetic.

Production, fees and tools marked as working inflate your channel totals and skew every recommendation. Label them Non-Working and they're tracked without contaminating media.

"Leverage previous year" is a draft, not a decision.

It copies last year's budget so you can edit it. Nothing is confirmed until you review and submit it yourself.

Sub-channel rows, always.

The platform can split a lump sum for you, but a file that already lists Paid Search and Paid Social separately maps cleaner and reports better. Export from your finance system at the finest grain you have.

History is a one-time import.

The Bulk Upload is for the past. Once you're live, campaigns are created in the platform and appear on the calendar on their own — don't keep re-importing.

SESSION FIVE

Who does what, and your checklist

Role	Owns	When
Marketing finance / ops	Prepares the budget file at sub-channel grain with a Working / Non-Working column; uploads it; confirms the category mapping.	Annually, before planning; on any re-forecast.
Marketing leadership	Reviews Active Channels and the pre-filled Media Plan before Strategy takes over.	After each confirmation.
Marketing Ops	Product Groups and Creative Focus Groups; the campaign-history CSV.	Onboarding, once.
Analytics owner	Sanity-checks channel totals against the source system after confirmation.	After each upload.

Setup checklist

Item	Where
Budget file at sub-channel grain, totals removed, Working / Non-Working column present	Your workbook / the template
Scope and Budget year selected	Plan Setup card
File uploaded and scanned; layout came in correctly	Upload your budget file
Every working category mapped; lump sums split	Review your budget
Submitted as final; Plan Setup shows ✓ Active	Plan Setup card
Active Channels match what you actually fund	Active Channels card
Channel totals reconcile to the source system	Budget detail / CSV export
Product Groups and Creative Focus Groups loaded	Bulk Upload → Step 1
Campaign history CSV uploaded; preview clean; valid rows loaded	Bulk Upload → Step 2
Past campaigns visible on the Marketing Calendar	Marketing Calendar

The closing thought

The budget file already exists. The only question is whether it sits in a folder or drives the platform that plans your year. Forty-five minutes turns it from a record of what you spent into the constraint every good recommendation respects.

Questions or a walkthrough with your team: reach your Verilume account lead.